‘He was cooperative and readily offered his services to the agency. He seems to be scared of being exposed and expelled from the USA in case we intimate the authorities. He has delivered some real nuggets,’ Narayanan informed Jindal.

It was time for Jindal to meet the man. He wanted a fair assessment before forging an alliance with the defector so the agency was not misled into some sort of calamitous situation. He discussed the matter with Bhardwaj and they decided Paris would be the place to play out the deception.

In espionage, recruiting a defector is done by two primary methods—pressurise the person with overwhelming evidence so that he or she surrenders and is mentally ready for exploitation, and consistently feed the defector with misinformation so that in case of a double cross, the handler has the last laugh. In January and February that year, the ISI had substantially increased its terror operations in India and Pakistan’s proxies were hell bent on damaging the social and economic structure of the country. Sethi took a circuitous route to Paris in order to avoid ISI surveillance on his movements. Bhardwaj, Jindal and Narayanan held two day-long meetings with the dangerous financier of terrorism in India. In Jindal’s words, Sethi sang non-stop. He shared the smallest details of the Sandhu-Khan network, revealing the role of ISI officers posted under diplomatic covers in London. The ISI had a special detachment in London for the India operation and a team of six officers had been deployed to create and continue sponsoring terrorist networks to carry out activities inside India. At the time, an ISI officer named Mahmood was running Sandhu and Khan. Sethi said he was not aware if the ISI was handling any other anti-India module. He provided a list of the officers, profiles of people connected to Khan and Sandhu and above all,